

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-09

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 21:9-17

9 Then the Lord spoke to Gad, David's seer, saying,

10 "Go and tell David, saying, 'Thus says the Lord: "I offer you three things; choose one of them for yourself, that I may do it to you." ' "

11 So Gad came to David and said to him, "Thus says the Lord: 'Choose for yourself,

12 either three years of famine, or three months to be defeated by your foes with the sword of your enemies overtaking you, or else for three days the sword of the Lord—the plague in the land, with the angel of the Lord destroying throughout all the territory of Israel.' Now consider what answer I should take back to Him who sent me."

13 And David said to Gad, "I am in great distress. Please let me fall into the hand of the Lord, for His mercies are very great; but do not let me fall into the hand of man."

14 So the Lord sent a plague upon Israel, and seventy thousand men of Israel fell.

15 And God sent an angel to Jerusalem to destroy it. As he was destroying, the Lord looked and relented of the disaster, and said to the angel who was destroying, "It is enough; now restrain your hand." And the angel of the Lord stood by the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite.

16 Then David lifted his eyes and saw the angel of the Lord standing between earth and heaven, having in his hand a drawn sword stretched out over Jerusalem. So David and the elders, clothed in sackcloth, fell on their faces.

17 And David said to God, "Was it not I who commanded the people to be numbered? I am the one who has sinned and done evil indeed; but these sheep, what have they done? Let Your hand, I pray, O Lord my God, be against me and my father's house, but not against Your people that they should be plagued."

II. Key Summary

- Through Gad the seer, God tells David to choose one of three punishments: three years of famine, three months of defeat by his enemies, or three days of plague (vv. 9–12).
 - David says he is in great distress but would rather fall into the hand of the Lord, because His mercies are very great. The plague comes and seventy thousand men of Israel die, but as the angel is about to destroy Jerusalem, God says, "It is enough; now restrain your hand" (vv. 13–15).
 - David sees the angel with a drawn sword, and he and the elders, clothed in sackcloth, fall on their faces. He admits that he is the one who ordered the census and asks God to punish him and his family instead of the people (vv. 16–17).
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III. Passage Analysis

Falling Into God's Hands

He cast himself upon the mercy of God (though he knew he was angry with him) and did not entertain any hard thoughts of him... Good men, even when God frowns upon them, think well of him. Though he slay me, yet will I trust in him. [1]

David had messed up badly and knew God was angry, yet he chose to let God handle it instead of people. He trusted that even while being disciplined, God's heart is full of mercy — and in the end God really did say, "It is enough."

A Shepherd Who Steps Up

Like a true shepherd, David asked that the punishment be upon him and his own household. [2]

David didn't blame anyone else. He said, "I'm the one who sinned — these sheep, what have they done?" He was willing to take the hit himself so his people could be spared.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time you did something wrong, who was the first person you went to? How did you face the consequences?

When David faced punishment, he chose to "fall into the hand of the LORD, for His mercies are very great" (v13). Just as the angel was about to destroy Jerusalem, God said, "It is enough; now restrain your hand" (v15). God's mercy is greater than His punishment.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (1 Chronicles 21), https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_021.cfm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on 1 Chronicles 21, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-21/>